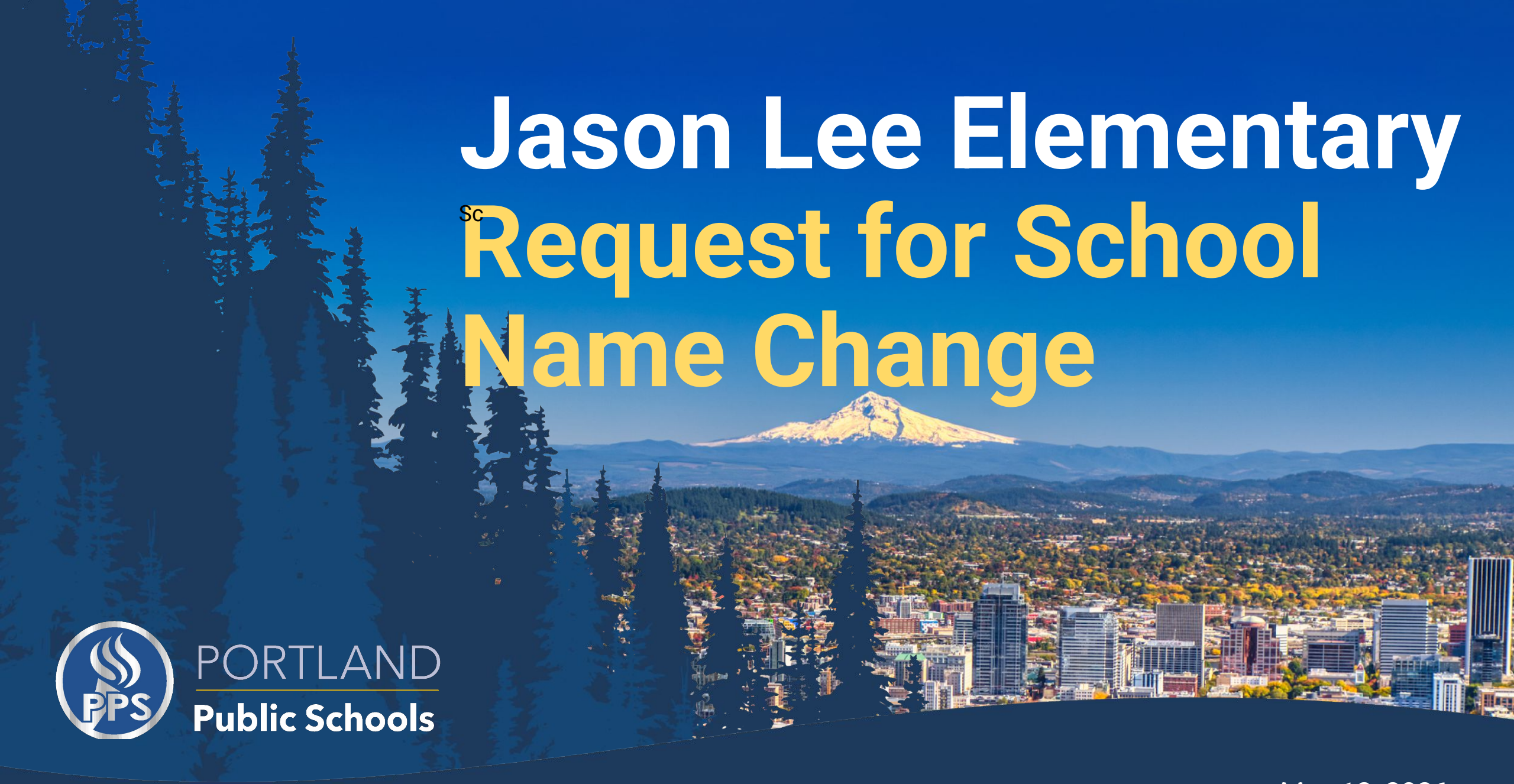
Jason Lee Elementary

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Request for School Name Change



PORTLAND
Public Schools

May 12, 2026

Renaming Committee Work

- The Jason Lee Renaming Committee was established in the spring of 2024, after the Board of Directors approved the request to allow the school to pursue a name change.
- The committee was made up of parents, staff, students and community members.
- The committee worked for two years to set parameters for the search of a new name, focusing on the goal of finding a name that inspired our diverse community of learners and their families.
- A total of 7 names of individuals and two symbolic names were put up for a vote after many discussions, lessons and community conversations.
- We held our voting process from Feb. 18 to March 18, and 438 votes were cast from a community of current students, alumni, family members, neighbors and staff.

Naming a school after an individual

One of the goals of our process was to honor the people who were in our region before the arrival of Jason Lee. We knew that settlers like him had had an impact on the removal of indigenous people from this land and their ways of life, and we learned that in their traditions, important places would not have been named after an individual. Naming places after individuals is more of a Western tradition.

Some of our research and conversations with professors at PSU with ties to our local tribes helped us understand that the native people from our region would instead have named locations after the natural environment.

Our community ultimately decided on one of the two symbolic names that are based on the natural world.

Voting Results

Name	Main D Ballot	Classroom D Ballot	Paper Ballot	Vietnamese D Ballot	Total
Sunrise Elementary	111	99	26	1	237
Hazel Ying Lee	59	9	4	1	73
Ursula K. Le Guin	42	1	0	0	43
Harriet Redmond	31	3	0	0	34
Western Red Cedar	24	11	3	0	38
Beatrice Cannady Morrow	16	1	1	0	18
Estella Ehelebe	13	5	1	0	19
Minoru Yasui	10	3	1	0	14
DeNorval Unthank	4	3	0	0	7
	310	135	36	2	483

Why Sunrise Elementary?

"This name came to me while I was driving to school one morning. Watching the sunrise over Rocky Butte I thought was something so special. Then over the next few weeks I really noticed the sun rising behind our school and across our playground.

I thought about the symbolism of a sunrise. It's the beginning of a new time. A new day. There's a lot of hope in a sunrise."

- Ms. Dar, kindergarten teacher



Thank you!